

ing on Broad Street. (For some reason, this whole financial district is full of candy vendors.) Anatoli is an ex-mechanic from Russia who says he makes \$25 a day selling jellied fruits to millionaires. "Heard any good tips?" I asked him. Anatoli smiled a big smile, and I could see his inflation hedge in gold teeth. "No tips," he said, "no tips." He insisted he'd never bought a share of stock in his life. Give him time. He'd only been in this country two years and was just learning to speak English. Soon he'll know enough to read the business pages.

Behind Anatoli, I saw several men and women loitering at the side door of the exchange building. They were dressed in colored lab jackets with large plastic identification badges pinned to the pockets. These people could have been taken for research chemists or a janitorial service, but they turned out to be traders from the exchange floor who do the actual buying and selling of the stocks. I asked a few of them for their stock picks, but they wouldn't answer. Maybe they weren't allowed.

The facade of the NYSE is worthy of a Temple of Minerva. This is no gaudy commercial building, but a sober shrine of white granite. Above the Greek columns is a busy little scene that's so unusual I drew a picture of it. In the middle is a lady with winged ears. Beneath her, two naked guys stare at some babies. Next to the naked guy on the right is a fully-dressed Pilgrim woman, while the naked guy on the left is shadowed by another fully-dressed person holding up a large wheel. At the far corner two more naked guys are absorbed in a game that looks like chess or backgammon, and at the near corner a similar duo seems to be committing arson. Whether this whole scene is supposed to illustrate the perils of investing, or whether it's supposed to be a group of heavenly shareholders who've reached their financial objectives was difficult to tell.

Inside the public entrance, an elevator took me to the third-floor visitor's gallery. This gallery is covered in red carpet from floor to ceiling, and it reminded me of a day-care center in a bowling alley or a padded cell in the bondage wing of a bordello. Educational displays are embedded in the vertical carpet. I studied all the old photographs and punched all the buttons that activate recorded messages. Two advisories stuck with me: "Make sure you